

Installing Tailscale for Remote Access

Tailscale lets you access the EcoNest dashboard from anywhere in the world as if you were on your home network. It creates an encrypted tunnel between your devices.

On the hub machine (macOS, Windows, or Linux)

Step 1 – Download and install Tailscale. Go to <https://tailscale.com/download> and select your operating system. Run the installer and follow the prompts.

Step 2 – Sign in. When prompted, sign in with a Google or Microsoft account. Use an account you will have permanent access to.

Step 3 – Note your Tailscale address. After signing in, Tailscale will show the machine's private IP address, which looks like 100.x.x.x. Write this down — you will use it to access Home Assistant remotely. This address never changes.

Step 4 – Enable auto-start.

For:

macOS: Click the Tailscale icon in the menu bar → Preferences → check "Start at Login."

Windows: Tailscale starts at login automatically after installation. You can confirm under Settings → General.

Linux: Run `sudo systemctl enable tailscaled` to enable it on boot.

On your phone

Step 5 – Install the Tailscale app from the App Store (iPhone) or Google Play (Android). Sign in with the same account used on the hub machine. Tap the toggle to connect. Allow the VPN permission when prompted.

Step 6 – Test remote access. Open a browser on your phone and go to <http://100.x.x.x:8123>, replacing the address with the one noted in Step 3. The Home Assistant login screen should appear. Log in with the credentials you created during Home Assistant setup.

Note: Tailscale must be turned on in the app on your phone whenever you want remote access. It can be left on permanently with no meaningful battery impact.